

When you open a new window whose launcher is already there on the sidebar, it will automatically convert to a button (much like a Mac dock and Windows 7 taskbar behaves). If your launcher is not already present on the bar, one is created. When you minimize the window, you'll find the window (predictably) going to its icon on the sidebar. If there is more than one window for the same application, they're all minimized to the same icon (once again predictable). When you click on the icon with multiple windows, the most recent one is restored (maximized or restored to the position it was). If you want to switch to the other window of the same application, you'd have to click the same icon again. This will show the different window thumbnails on the screen. Select one from them. If you've used Compiz Fusion, you won't be surprised by this. This is somewhat similar to the way Windows 7 displays windows on its taskbar with AERO when you hover over the taskbar button.

The Unity interface depends heavily on Compiz to show its beautiful effects. So it's important that you have the hardware support for it. If your display adapter hardware is not potent enough to support Compiz or suffers incompatibility because of driver unavailability, you might not be able to run Unity on your desktop. In such a case, Ubuntu will notify you about it and will revert back to the classic Gnome interface. It is to be noted that the Gnome interface which comes with version 11.04 is not updated to the third version.

In case Unity is able to run on your machine and you're not happy with it for some reason and want to revert back to the default Gnome interface, Ubuntu would be happy to help you. All you need to remember for this is the password of your account. The procedure to change the interface is simple and as follows:

- ▶ Log out of Unity.
- ▶ On the login screen, first select your username.
- ▶ While Ubuntu is still asking you for the password, on the bottom panel change the interface from 'Ubuntu' to 'Ubuntu Classic'.
- ▶ Sign in.

You shouldn't be having the classic Gnome interface on the desktop.

## The Gnome shell

Although we need not talk about the Gnome interface, there might be the case that you're completely new to the Linux world and are unaware that a computer can look and behave in a way other than Windows does.